

Prabhav Bhatnagar

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EDUCATION

Aalto University

PhD in CS — Expanding the Understanding of Game Feel in Digital Game Design

Espoo, Finland

Nov. 2022 – Present

Aalto University

MSc in CCIS — Major in Game Design and Production

Espoo, Finland

Aug. 2020 – July 2022

EXPERIENCE

Independent Game Developer

SideLine Studio

Feb. 2025 – Present

Espoo, Finland

- Developing the game Aether-07, a 3D first-person physics based puzzle game.
- Acting as sole programmer, handling custom physics interactions, core gameplay, shaders, and adaptive audio integration to build novel gameplay.
- Expanded the project from a solo developed MVP with 12+ levels, to a multidisciplinary team of 5.

Doctoral Researcher

Aalto University, School of Computer Science

Nov. 2022 – Present

Espoo, Finland

- Conducting explorative research on game feel and advancing methods for research through game design, with expertise in artifact-based research involving game making.
- Independently developed games and tools for research, and conducted in-depth interviews and playtests.

Freelance Quality Assurance and Data Analyst

Mopeful Games

July 2022 & March – June 2025

Helsinki, Finland

- Provided QA for the games Fashion Police Squad (94% positive on steam), and Wardrum (to be released).
- Worked closely with the design team to provide detailed reports and test videos on issues ranging from bugs, playability, UX, balancing, design, etc.
- Prepared dashboards on gameanalytics.com to track and analyze player performance, pickup and character selection rates, combat statistics, progression unlocks, among others.

Teaching Assistant

Aalto University

Sept. 2021 – Sept 2026

Espoo, Finland

- Served as the TA in ‘Software Studies for Game Designers’ for 5 consecutive years with classes of 25+ students.
- Assisted beginner students with learning Unity, Godot, and Unreal through one-on-one mentoring and interactive workshops, while also assisting advanced students with topics such as procedural animation, lighting and vfx.
- Prepared lectures and teaching material on topics such as version control, game engine fundamentals, shader programming, visual programming, among others.

GAME PROJECT HIGHLIGHTS

Shadow Puppy Shenanigans | Programming, Game Design & Project Management

- Programmed mechanics and designed 15+ puzzles for a block-pushing game with light and shadow mechanics.
- Reached finals in Bit1 game competition and demo-ed the game during an IGDA gathering.

Chromatic Cherry Chase | Programming & Game Design

- Developed a Celeste-inspired platformer during my master’s thesis, handling programming, level and game design.
- Designed and iterated on 5-minute player onboarding for online tests leading to positive reviews by 200+ players who took part in the online playtesting.

ACHIEVEMENTS

2026: Draknek and Friends - New Voices Grant Recipient for Puzzle Game Design

2025: FDG’25 - Early Career Best Paper Award

2022: Bit1 student game competition finalist

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: C#, GLSL, GDScript, Java, C++, Python

Software: Unity, Godot, Unreal, Git, Audacity, Reaper